Everyday AI

The Cowork Skills Workbook

From First Session to Power User

A Step-by-Step Guide with Exercises

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How to Use This Workbook

Work through each tier in order. Every exercise uses a Cowork skill — just type the command shown. Write directly in this workbook. Skip nothing.

Where Are You?

Complete this self-assessment to find your starting tier.

My role:

My industry:

Biggest time-waster:

Tools I use daily:

CHECK EVERYTHING THAT APPLIES:

- ☐ I have never opened Cowork START AT TIER 1
- ☐ I tried Cowork but got generic results
- ☐ I have CLAUDE.md or preferences set up START AT TIER 2
- ☐ I use Skills & Automations regularly
- ☐ I have scheduled or dispatched tasks START AT TIER 3
- ☐ I have built my own custom skills START AT TIER 4
- ☐ I run multi-step domain workflows START AT TIER 5

My starting tier:

My goal for this workbook:

What Is Cowork?

× AI CHAT

You type a question. It types an answer.

Output lives in the chat window only.

Every conversation starts from zero.

Cannot touch your files or tools.

You copy-paste everything manually.

✓ COWORK

You delegate a task. It does the work.

Output is real files on your computer.

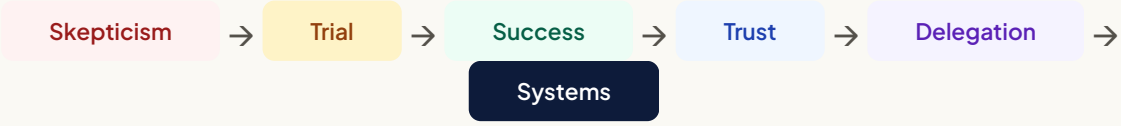
Remembers your preferences & context.

Connects to your tools and workflows.

Runs tasks on schedule, even while you sleep.

The Trust Progression

Every Cowork user follows this journey. This workbook walks you through each stage.



> **The Key Insight**
>
> **Chat answers questions. Cowork does work.**

Think of it this way: AI chat is like texting a smart friend for advice. Cowork is like hiring a skilled assistant who sits at your computer, reads your files, creates documents, and executes your instructions — all while learning how you prefer things done.

Cowork can create and edit files on your machine, remember your communication style, run skills (reusable task templates), schedule recurring tasks, and work across multiple projects simultaneously. It is not just smarter autocomplete. It is a work partner.

This workbook gives you 15 hands-on exercises that take you from "what does this button do?" to "I just saved 5 hours this week." Each exercise uses a skill from the Cowork Skills Library — type the command, do the work, fill in the blanks. No fluff, no theory-only sections. Every page is an action.

Before You Begin

You need: Claude Pro or Team subscription with Cowork access • The Cowork Skills Library installed (see README.md) • 2–3 hours total across all tiers • This workbook (printed or on-screen)

TIER 1

Onboarding — Your First 15 Minutes

Meet Priya

Marketing Manager at a 30-person SaaS company. Uses ChatGPT daily for brainstorming and copy. Has Claude Pro but has never opened Cowork. Worried about "one more tool to learn" and whether it is worth the context-switching cost.

> "What if it breaks my files? What if it's just ChatGPT with extra steps? I barely have time to learn what I already have."

Your turn: Do you relate to Priya? Write down what is holding YOU back:

.....

Exercise 1 Your Safe First Task

Time: 5 minutes • Skill: `/safe-first-task`

Open Cowork and type: `/safe-first-task`

I told Cowork my role is: .....

It created these files: .....

Was this different from ChatGPT? ☐ Yes ☐ No

The biggest difference I noticed: .....

On a scale of 1–10, how useful was the output? .....

Exercise 2 Map Your Work

Time: 10 minutes • Skill: `/what-can-cowork-do`

Type `/what-can-cowork-do` to see Cowork's full capability set. Then fill in:

TASK I DO REGULARLY	TIME IT TAKES	COULD COWORK HELP?	WHICH SKILL?
.....	.....	☐ Yes ☐ No	.....
.....	.....	☐ Yes ☐ No	.....
.....	.....	☐ Yes ☐ No	.....
.....	.....	☐ Yes ☐ No	.....
.....	.....	☐ Yes ☐ No	.....

Exercise 3 The Side-by-Side Test

Time: 5 minutes • Skill: `/cowork-vs-chat-demo`

Type `/cowork-vs-chat-demo` and watch Cowork run the same prompt in chat mode and Cowork mode.

Chat produced: .....

Cowork produced: .....

The difference that matters most: .....

Priya's After: "Okay, I see it now. This IS different. It made actual files on my computer. The marketing brief it generated was better than what I spent 45 minutes writing last week."

✓ Ready for Tier 2?

- ☐ Completed safe first task
- ☐ Can explain the Chat vs. Cowork difference in one sentence
- ☐ Identified 3+ tasks Cowork could help with

TIER 2

Foundation — Make It Yours

The #1 reason people get generic AI results: they skip this step.

The next 30 minutes permanently change every future session. Time investment: ~30 min.

Meet Marcus

Solo management consultant. Tried Cowork twice — both times the output was generic, formal, and nothing like how he actually writes. Thinks Cowork is "ChatGPT with extra steps." Almost canceled his subscription.

> "Last time the output was useless — I spent more time editing it than writing from scratch. Why would this time be different?"

Exercise 4 The 15-Minute Setup

Time: 15 minutes • Skill: `/cowork-setup-wizard` • **This is the most important exercise in the workbook.**

Type `/cowork-setup-wizard`

My role: .....

My industry: .....

My biggest challenge:

.....

I prefer output that is:

☐ Formal ☐ Conversational ☐ Direct ☐ Detailed

Tools I connected:

.....

- ☐ Preferences saved to CLAUDE.md
- ☐ Project folder created
- ☐ Tested with a sample prompt — output matches my style

Exercise 5 Find Your Voice

Time: 10 minutes • Skill: `/teach-your-voice`

Type `/teach-your-voice` and paste a sample of your real writing when prompted.

3 words that describe how I communicate: .....

Phrases I use often: .....

Phrases I NEVER use: .....

The "after" output sounds like me: ☐ Yes ☐ Almost ☐ Needs work

If "Needs work," what to adjust: .....

Exercise 6 The Delegation Framework

Time: 10 minutes • Skill: `/delegation-coach`

× BAD DELEGATION

"Write me a blog post about productivity."

No context. No constraints. No definition of "done." You will hate the output.

✓ GOOD DELEGATION

"Write a 1,200-word blog post for my SaaS audience about async communication. Conversational tone, 3 subheadings, include a CTA to our free trial. Reference our style guide in /docs."

Now rewrite YOUR most common task as a proper delegation:

Task: .....

"Done" looks like: .....

Context needed: .....

Constraints: .....

Exercise 7 Your Safety Net

Time: 5 minutes • Skill: `/safety-and-audit`

Type `/safety-and-audit`

- ☐ Change log set up (Cowork logs what it modifies)
- ☐ Off-limits folders defined
- ☐ Drafts/final workflow in place (Cowork writes to /drafts, you promote to /final)

Folders Cowork should NEVER touch: .....

File types Cowork should always ask before editing:

.....

My review process before accepting Cowork output:

.....

Marcus's After: "Wait — this actually sounds like ME now. The client proposal it just wrote? I changed two sentences. Two. This is not ChatGPT with extra steps. This is a junior consultant who studied my writing."

✓ Ready for Tier 3?

- ☐ CLAUDE.md configured with my preferences
- ☐ Voice profile trained — output sounds like me
- ☐ Can write a proper delegation brief
- ☐ Safety guardrails in place

TIER 3

Best Practices — Build Systems

The difference between "I use AI" and "AI works for me" is systems.

You are about to cross that line. ~30 min investment.

Meet Elena

Operations Director at a real estate firm. Uses Cowork for basic document drafting and email replies. Knows she is only using 30% of its capability. Every session starts from scratch because she has no memory system or workflows set up.

> "I'm productive, but every session starts from zero. I keep re-explaining the same context. There has to be a better way."

Exercise 8 Health Check

Time: 5 minutes • Skill: `/cowork-health-check`

Type `/cowork-health-check` and record your scores:

Preferences	.....	/10
Connected Tools	.....	/10
Skills & Automations	.....	/10
Workflows	.....	/10
Advanced Features	.....	/10
Total	.....	/50

My weakest area: .....

Biggest quick win: .....

Score goal after Tier 3: ..... / 50

Exercise 9 Build Your Memory

Time: 10 minutes • Skill: `/memory-system`

Type `/memory-system`

Context files created: .....

Key facts Cowork now remembers: .....

☐ Project-level memory configured

☐ Tested: started new session and Cowork remembered my context

Before memory: "I had to explain ..... every time."

After memory: "Cowork already knew ....."

Exercise 10 Your First Workflow

Time: 10 minutes • Skill: `/workflow-builder`

Type `/workflow-builder`

Task I turned into a workflow: .....

Number of steps in the workflow: .....

Time this task took manually: ..... minutes

Time with the workflow: ..... minutes

Time saved per week: ..... minutes

Elena's After: "I went from 22/50 to 38/50 in one sitting. The memory system alone saves me 10 minutes per session. I used to re-explain our property listing format every single time — now it just knows."

✓ Ready for Tier 4?

☐ Health check score above 30/50

☐ Memory system active — context persists across sessions

☐ At least one reusable workflow built

☐ Can explain the difference between a skill and a workflow

TIER 4

Advancement — Automate & Extend

This is where Cowork stops being a tool and becomes a team member that works.

From "I tell Cowork what to do" → "Cowork does it before I ask."

Meet Jordan

Head of Content at a B2B startup. Has Cowork fully personalized and uses workflows daily. Ready to go further: wants tasks that run on schedule, the ability to delegate from mobile, and custom skills for the team's unique processes.

> "I'm fast with Cowork, but I still have to be at my desk. What if it could do the Monday metrics pull before I even wake up?"

Exercise 11 First Autopilot Task

Time: 10 minutes • Skill: `/first-scheduled-task`

Type `/first-scheduled-task`

Task I scheduled: .....

Schedule: ☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly Day/time: .....

Output location: .....

☐ Confirmed: task ran successfully on schedule

☐ Output was usable without editing

Exercise 12 Remote Control (Dispatch)

Time: 5 minutes • Skill: `/dispatch-starter`

Type `/dispatch-starter`

Task I dispatched remotely: .....

Dispatched from: ☐ Phone ☐ Tablet ☐ Another computer

Result was ready when I checked: ☐ Yes ☐ No — issue: .....

Exercise 13 Create Your Own Skill

Time: 15 minutes • Skill: `/skill-creator-guide`

Type `/skill-creator-guide`

Skill name: .....

What it does: .....

Who will use it: ☐ Just me ☐ My team ☐ Anyone

Inputs it needs: .....

Outputs it produces: .....

☐ Skill file created and saved

☐ Tested with real data

☐ Output quality acceptable without editing

Time this skill saves per use: ..... minutes

Jordan's After: "Monday morning: metrics report was already in my inbox when I woke up. I dispatched three content briefs from my phone during lunch. And I built a skill for our unique editorial review process that the whole team now uses. Cowork is not a tool anymore — it's infrastructure."

✓ Ready for Tier 5?

☐ At least one scheduled task running

☐ Successfully dispatched a remote task

☐ Created a custom skill

☐ Understand the difference between skills, workflows, and automations

TIER 5

Domain Workflows — The Compound Effect

This is where the hours-per-week savings become real.

Each workflow compounds every skill you built in Tiers 1–4.

These five workflows chain multiple skills together. Each one automates an entire business function. Choose the one closest to your role.

WORKFLOW	SKILL COMMAND	BEST FOR	COMPOUNDS WITH
Weekly Business Pulse	`/weekly-business-pulse`	Founders, Ops leaders	Scheduled tasks + Memory
Meeting Machine	`/meeting-machine`	Managers, consultants	Voice + Context + Dispatch
Content Engine	`/content-engine`	Marketers, creators	Voice + Workflows + Schedule
Client Context System	`/client-context-system`	Agencies, services	Memory + Safety + Delegation
Research Synthesizer	`/research-synthesizer`	Analysts, strategists	Memory + Workflows + Parallel

Exercise 14 Choose Your Domain

Time: 15 minutes • Pick the workflow above that fits your role best.

Workflow I chose: .....

Why this one fits my role: .....

Run the skill command and record:

Files/outputs it generated: .....

Skills it chained together: .....

Time this would take manually: ..... minutes

Time with the workflow: ..... minutes

Quality of output (1–10): .....

Exercise 15 The Compound Effect — Your Full Journey

Time: 10 minutes • Reflection exercise

Look back at every exercise you completed. Trace the compound effect:

THE COMPOUND CHAIN

Setup (Ex 4) taught Cowork your preferences →

Voice (Ex 5) made every output sound like you →

Memory (Ex 9) made context persist across sessions →

Workflows (Ex 10) made recurring tasks one-click →

Schedule (Ex 11) made them run without you →

Domain Workflow (Ex 14) chained it all together

My most impactful exercise was # ..... because:

.....

The skill I will use most often: .....

If I could only keep 3 skills, they would be:

1. .....
2. .....
3. .....

What surprised me most about this journey:

.....

What I will tell a colleague about Cowork: .....

Journey Complete

TIER 1: ONBOARDING

- ☐ Safe first task completed
- ☐ Work mapped to Cowork capabilities
- ☐ Chat vs. Cowork difference clear

TIER 2: FOUNDATION

- ☐ Setup wizard completed
- ☐ Voice profile trained
- ☐ Delegation framework learned
- ☐ Safety guardrails in place

TIER 3: BEST PRACTICES

- ☐ Health check score: ..... /50
- ☐ Memory system active
- ☐ First workflow built

TIER 4: ADVANCEMENT

- ☐ Scheduled task running
- ☐ Remote dispatch tested
- ☐ Custom skill created

TIER 5: DOMAIN WORKFLOWS

- ☐ Domain workflow selected & run
- ☐ Compound effect traced
- ☐ Top 3 skills identified

FINAL HEALTH CHECK

Run `/cowork-health-check` again.

New score ..... /50

Improvement: + ... points

The Bottom Line

Hours saved per week: .....

Tasks fully automated: .....

Skills I use daily: .....

My 3 most-used skills:

1. .....
2. .....
3. .....

What I do with the time I got back:

.....

.....

Everyday AI

Start Your Journey

Open Cowork and type:

```
/safe-first-task
```

Full Skills Library & Documentation

github.com/everyday-ai/cowork-skills-library

Learn more at

everydayaiapp.com

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